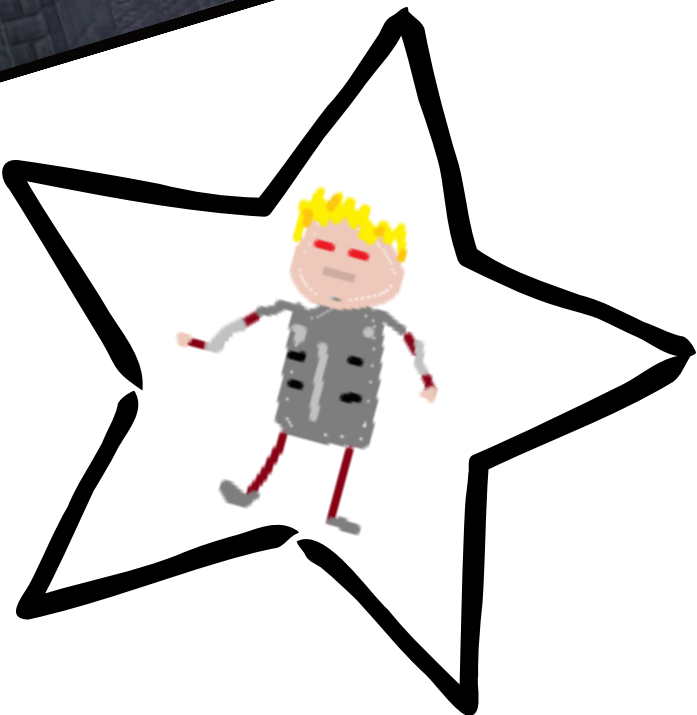




Rusty's Report

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Freshers: New Kids on the Block

by WillowSings

Every season brings a new batch of players to TitanCraft, but this year's Freshers have made sure no one could accuse them of quietly settling in.

After arriving on the server, we claimed a village just off the east tunnel of the Nether Hub and transformed it into a whimsical fairytale neighborhood. At first glance it's charming—storybook cottages, magical builds, and enough flowers to satisfy even the pickiest woodland fairy. Spend more than five minutes there, however, and you'll probably witness a public execution, stumble across a suspicious ritual, or hear someone enthusiastically inviting others to their own demise.

The Freshers are an eclectic collection of personalities. Our ranks include wizards, chickens, angels, thieves, trees, flowers, spicy and chilly seasonings, lovable idiots, and countless other characters that somehow manage to coexist without completely burning the village down. (Mostly.)



Thanks to Gava and Chicken, the village quickly gained an HOA complete with rules, regulations, and absolutely no tolerance for... well... anything. To maintain morale, the Freshers responded in the only reasonable way possible: by constructing gallows and holding volunteer sacrifices. We would like to emphasize that all murders are entirely consensual. Accidental murders, while frowned upon, are generally forgiven after a suitable amount of laughter.

The village is also home to our beloved pet Warden, Decked Out 4—better known as DO4. We visit him regularly to make sure he doesn't get lonely. In return, he murders us one by one. It's his way of saying he cares.

Several members of TitanCraft have suggested that these activities make us some sort of unsavory social club.

We categorically deny these allegations.

Yes, we own matching ceremonial robes.

Yes, we've gathered together to perform elaborate rituals in pursuit of advancements.

And yes, outsiders occasionally witness a circle of robed figures chanting around a sacrifice.

But we assure you, those things are entirely unrelated.

Pranks Are a Love Language

Of course, no group of friends would be complete without a healthy dose of harmless mischief. The Freshers have embraced the long-standing TitanCraft tradition of pranking with creativity, good humor, and one very important rule: everyone should be laughing by the end of it.

PoloBear logged in one day to discover his base had been encased inside a giant glass sphere, transforming his home into an oversized snow globe. Wizard's base found itself overrun by an army of mischievous minions. Stitcher quietly handed out glass panes to unsuspecting players, leaving them wondering why their inventory suddenly appeared to have several empty slots. Heliconian awoke to find an adorable family of worms had mysteriously taken up residence inside their pumpkin. Those are only a handful of examples—I could probably fill an entire newsletter with Freshers pranks alone.

(Disclaimer: All pranks are consensual, server rules are respected, and the goal is always to create memorable moments rather than frustration.)



Beyond the Chaos

For all the volunteer sacrifices, suspicious robes, and questionable decision-making, the Freshers have also become one of the server's biggest sources of encouragement. When someone loses their gear to lava, there's usually someone ready to help replace it. If a player gets stranded or needs rescuing from a dangerous situation, volunteers appear almost immediately. Community projects attract eager helping hands, and whether it's gathering resources, lending an extra pickaxe, or simply showing up to cheer someone on, the Freshers have proven that underneath all the chaos is a group of people who genuinely enjoy making TitanCraft a better place.

As many of us have settled into the season, we've spread across the world to begin work on our own mega bases. During a recent group base tour, we realized something surprising: many of us are independently building minigames into our bases for others to enjoy. Whether you're exploring the End, wandering through forests, or flying over distant mountains, chances are you'll eventually stumble across a Fresher build—and probably a new adventure waiting for you.



What's Next?

While we'll always be remembered as this season's Freshers, we know we won't be the new kids forever. That has sparked an important discussion: what exactly do you call last season's Freshers? The current frontrunner, "Sophies" (supposedly short for sophomores), has received... mixed reviews, at best.

Our naming committee is hard at work searching for something a little more dignified—or at least a little less embarrassing. We hope to announce our new official title in the next edition of the newsletter.

Assuming, of course, the committee survives the next volunteer sacrifice.

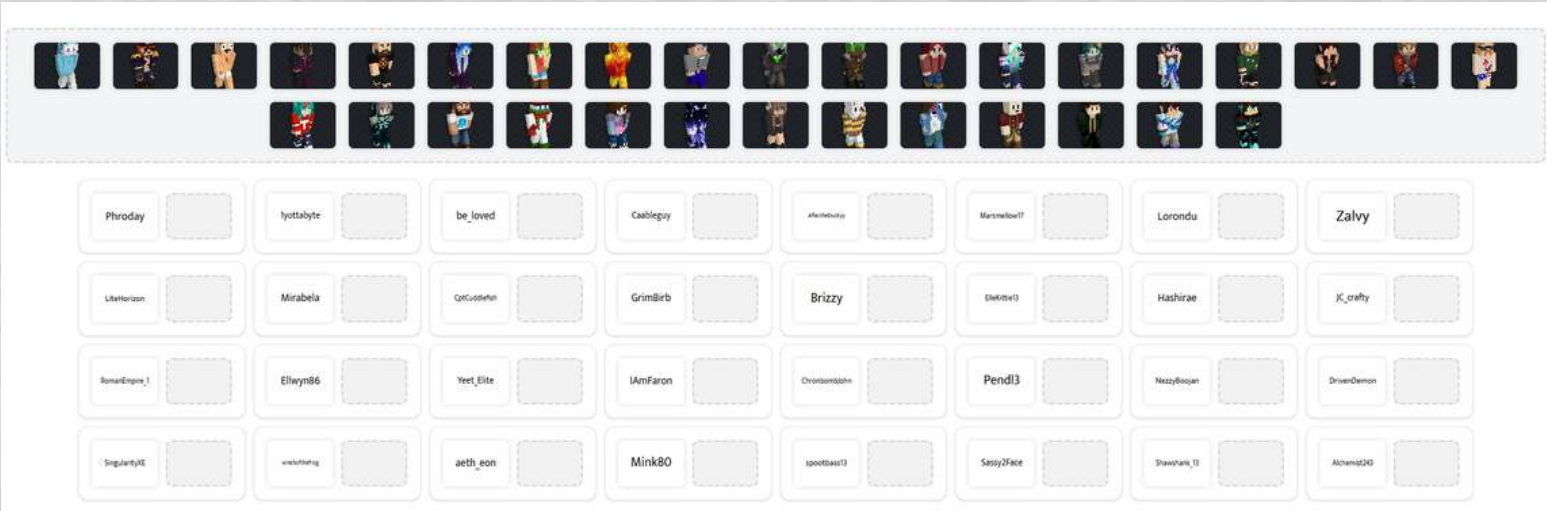


Editor's note: Take care to notice that in 90% (okay, 2) of the pictures accompanying this article, phantoms are present. It appears the Freshers also never sleep. Not sure if this is significant, but your dedicated editor thought it notable.



Because I am usually off doing Phroday things, knowing what you all look like is at best limited to the faces I see in the chat window. And even that is a bit of a stretch because I go chat blind when I'm in the weeds working on a build. Let's say you, yes you the random Titan reading this were to land in front of me with your nametag obscured, I would cry stranger danger, run away, and probably pee myself a little bit. So for this month's puzzle / game, I decided to make one I would fail at. A simple matching game where you match the skin of a player to their name. I yanked the skins from NameMC and hold no guarantees this is what your current skin is.

Time to play Name that Titan!



Post Office Now Open!

by wrathofthefrog

This seasons post office is now complete. Come claim your box and enjoy the build there are 250 boxes to choose from.



by melodioustear

For some of us, photography looks like lugging around a big camera on treks out of the house, touching grass and setting up the perfect shot. Then, there's virtual photography - the practice of taking pictures through screenshot or photo mode, often using game mods to assist in doing so. The virtual photography community is big, spanning all manner of games, but isn't often seen in Minecraft. This has started to change, with videos like Mumbo's Hermitcraft S11 ep 22, where he turned virtual photographs into in-game paintings. Building on work by Minecraft virtual photographers such as BlockSnaps (on Instagram), Mumbo used the Flashback mod to create a sort of photo mode in Minecraft. Combined with the use of shaders and traditional photography and art techniques for framing shots, he was able to create some amazing artwork - and with the incredible work of builders on Titancraft, we can do the same thing here!

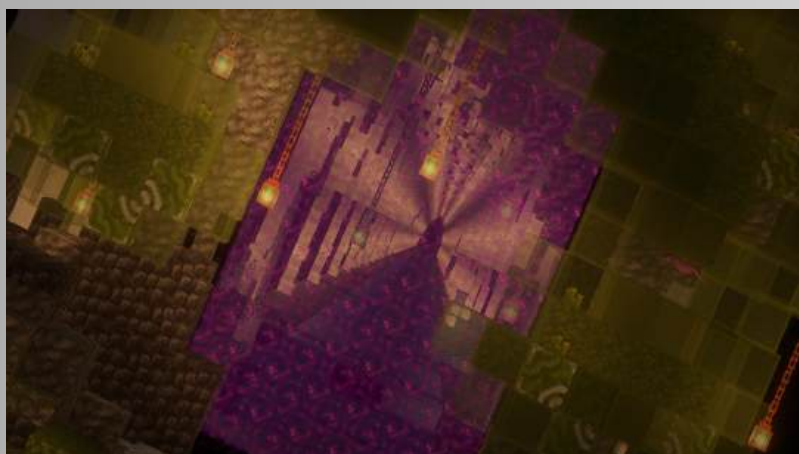
As the Rusty Report's latest roving photo reporter, I'm excited to bring my amateur virtual photography skills to Titancraft. This is the first edition of the column, and to kick us off we have three huge build releases from this month on TC, starting with Emptyhead's Casino:



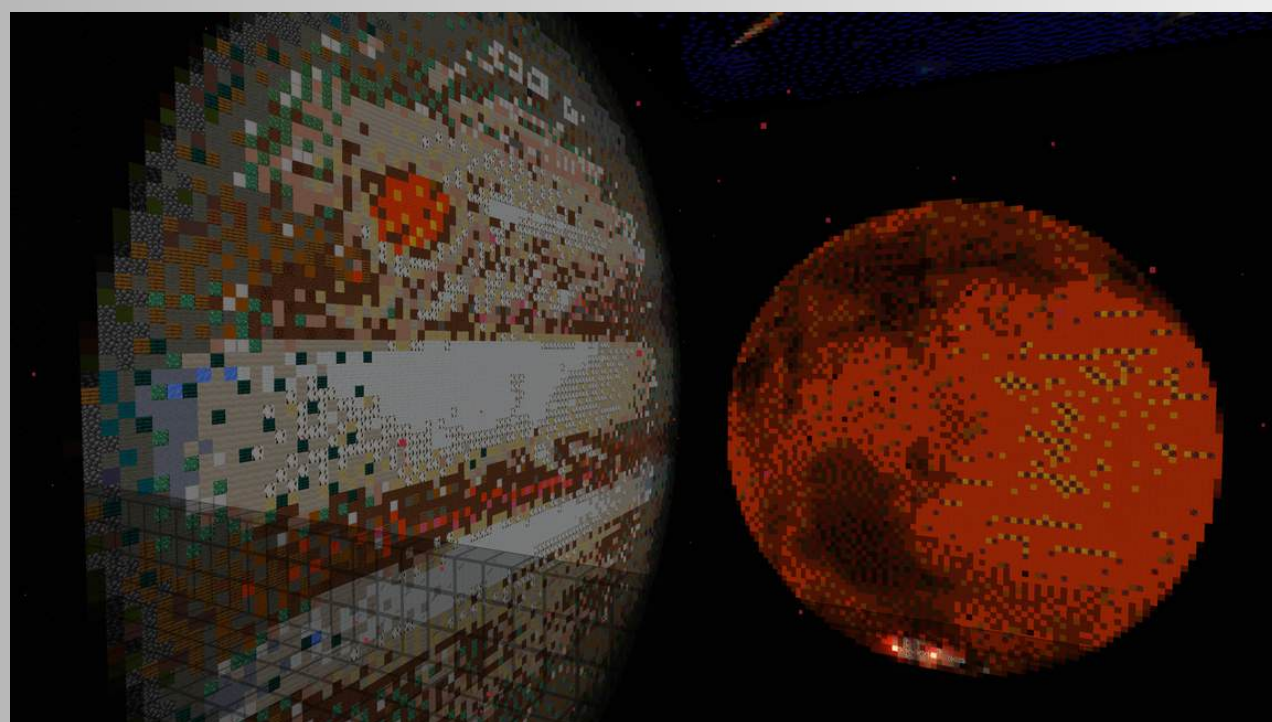
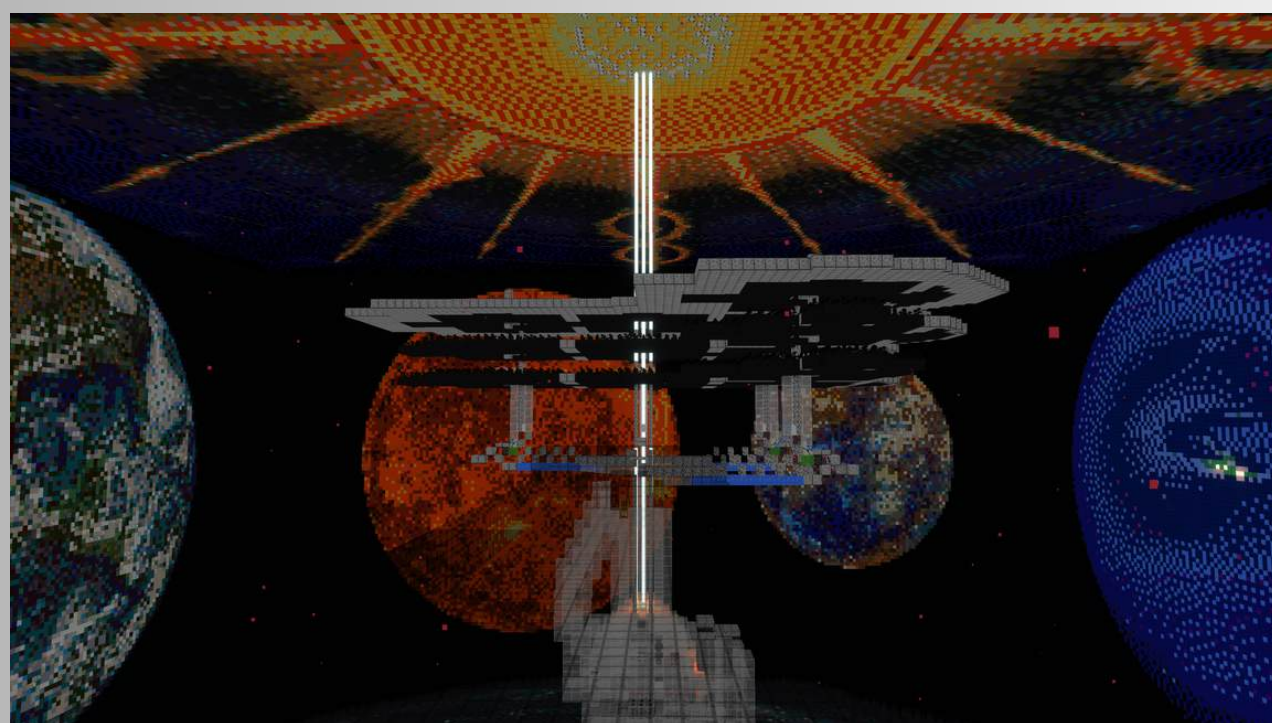
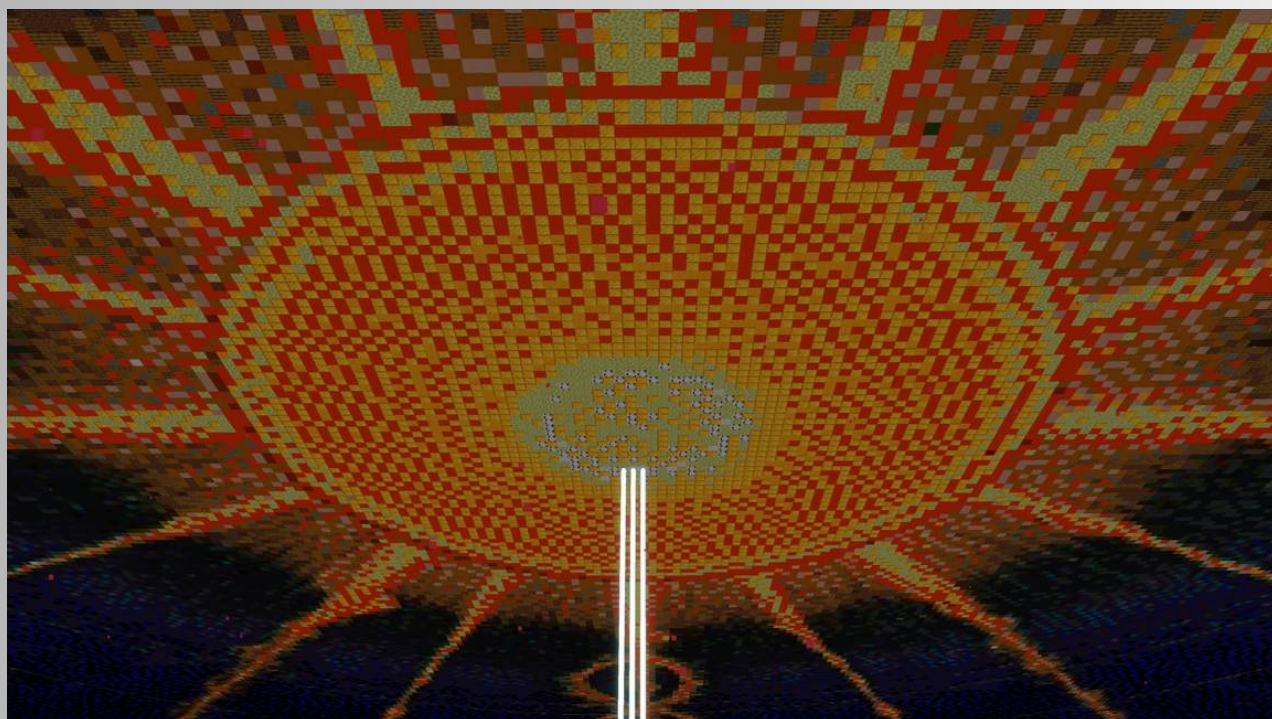
Later on in the month, we had the amazing nether hub release after a huge amount of work from Shorty and team. These first shots are taken using Photon shaders:



These second shots show you a bit more of how virtual photography can build on the atmosphere of a build. These shots are taken in Solas, Eclipse, and Complementary shaders respectively.



Lastly, we have the incredible surrounds of the wither skeleton farm. The important thing in these shots was conveying the scale of the build, whilst also navigating the nether fog. In the end, nether fog was disabled for these, as well as using Glimmer shaders which help keep the colours punchy whilst retaining the clarity needed to show the scale.



From the Desk of the Mods...

ZITS braving new content in The Above!

It's almost here! In case you didn't know, The Above is a concept by Tango that takes an adventure map to the next level. And whether you've already explored The Above in past seasons or have only heard stories, we hope you can help us celebrate It's opening in a special ZITS stream!

This year Titancraft turns 10! And we wanted to do something special for it; so we've called in the experts to brave the new content we've added for the 10-year anniversary!

Come watch the heroic cries and manly screams on Saturday, August 1, 2026 2:00 PM (EST)

Note: The Above will open for all of Titancraft Server after this event.



Classifieds:



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